

Rick Stoneback

Full Stack Software Engineer & Tech Lead

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Engineer & Tech Lead, Cox Automotive - 2019 to present - Burlington, VT
SE2 (2019-2022) → Sr. SE (2022-2024) → Lead SE (2024-present)

- Serve as Tech Lead for a 4-engineer team, owning technical direction, code quality, and delivery. Mentor other engineers and collaborate cross-team on architecture and technology decisions. Work with internal customers to translate ambiguous requirements into shipped decisions, supporting them before and after development.
- Lead adoption of spec-driven development on the team, using Claude to turn requirements into detailed, AI-executable specifications before implementation – improving handoff quality between planning and delivery.
- Author and maintain custom Claude Skills that package repeatable prompts and workflows into reusable, shareable tools, increasing the speed of development.
- Develop GraphQL APIs to expose datasets via an Apollo federated supergraph, leveraged in products that dealerships use daily as part of the car selling process.
- Own a URL redirect service utilized across the org when emails/SMS are sent to consumers, enabling powerful mapping of known consumer data to their anonymous website usage. Handles peak traffic of 300k RPM and thousands of clicks per day.
- Develop Kafka Streams apps for real-time collection and transformation of automotive website analytics data, sent by thousands of websites including Autotrader and KBB.
- Develop serverless ETL pipelines to enhance and combine massive datasets, using AWS Glue, Lambda, ECS, SNS, SQS, S3, Dynamo, Aurora Postgres, and Step Functions.

Staff Software Engineer, MicroStrain - 2008 to 2019 - Williston, VT

Internship (2008-2010) → SE1 (2010-2012) → SE2 (2012-2014) → Sr. SE (2014-2018) → Staff SE (2018-2019)

- Lead developer on [MSCL](#), an open-source library used to communicate with MicroStrain's wireless and wired sensors, available in C++, C#, and Python. Directly supported customers using the library to develop their own custom software.
- Product owner and full-stack developer on [SensorConnect](#), the main PC software for all of MicroStrain's sensors. C++ backend, with HTML/JavaScript/WebGL frontend. Built from the ground-up to modernize the company's software offering.
- Designed and developed the website for MicroStrain's web app, SensorCloud.com.

EDUCATION

B.S. in Game Programming, Champlain College - 2010 - Burlington, VT

TECHNICAL SKILLS / EXPERIENCE

- Scala, Java, C++, C#, Python
- TypeScript, JavaScript, React
- Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker
- Terraform, CDK, GitHub Actions
- New Relic, PagerDuty
- Claude Code, GitHub Copilot
- Spec-Driven Development, GitHub Spec-Kit
- SNS, SQS, S3
- Lambda, EC2, ECS, Fargate, Glue
- API Gateway, WAF, IAM
- EventBridge
- Secrets Manager, Cloudwatch
- DynamoDB, RDS, Aurora PostgreSQL
- Snowflake

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Hour of Code - led coding sessions for elementary students at my daughter's school.

Camp Ta-Kum-Ta - maintained grounds and facilities for a camp serving children with cancer.

Habitat for Humanity - helped build homes for families in need of safe, affordable housing.

Common Roots - built fencing and worked in the farm fields at a food equity nonprofit.

VT Green-Up Day - helped coworkers clean up over 2 tons of trash each year.